The Next Safia

Can you predict how a location will perform before we open there?

2 WEEKS	1–100 SALES INDEX	LOCATION + ML + RESEARCH

A note before you start

When I came to Safia, I was in the middle of my graduation project, work, university studies, and exams. It was not exactly the easiest time to start something new.

My manager, Maxmud Salimov, told me something that stayed with me: our purpose was not to push me immediately just to get a little short-term result. The team needed me for the improvements we want to make in the future. He told me to finish my exams first, and then we would continue building.

I want you to know the same thing before you do this case study. The team here cares about long-term potential. Yes, Safia sells cakes - but our ambition is to become a leading company in how technology is used to build, automate, secure, and improve a real business.

So I am not going to judge this only by how polished the final result looks. I want to understand how you think when the solution is not already written for you: what you notice, what you try, what you question, what you learn, and what else you are capable of bringing to the problem.

Use this case study to show me your skills - including the ones I did not explicitly ask for.

Good luck.

Fahriddin Hayitov
AI Projects Lead

YOUR CHALLENGE

Choose a place. Predict its potential.

Safia wants to understand how strong a new branch location could be **before** we invest in opening it. Your task is to build a model or research system that can take a proposed location and return an expected sales index from 1 to 100.

WHAT YOU RECEIVE **SampleSales_01-10_Sep_2026.xlsx**

The file contains anonymized/indexed branch performance data for 127 Safia branches in Uzbekistan, including coordinates, daily sales index, orders index and average-check index for 10 days.

Real sales amounts are not provided. The values are placed on one relative scale: the highest single-day sales in the supplied data = 100.

What the model should understand

A location is not just latitude and longitude. The surroundings matter. Your job is to decide what information is meaningful and how to turn it into evidence.

Competition
What similar businesses exist nearby?

People & activity
Where do people work, live, study, shop or pass through?

Accessibility
Roads, transport, parking, walkability, visibility and movement.

Safia context
Nearby branches, possible overlap, city/area differences and other signals you believe matter.

These are examples, not a checklist. You are expected to discover and justify your own factors and data sources.

How we will test it

Your model will see locations it has never seen before.

The supplied branches are there so you can research, train and test your ideas. During evaluation, we will run the solution on real Safia branches that are intentionally not included in your file and compare the predicted 1–100 sales index with their hidden performance. We may also give you a proposed new branch location and ask the system to evaluate it.

What to send back

- Your working model / code and a clear way for us to give it a location and receive the 1–100 prediction.
- A short explanation of your research process, the factors you chose, data sources, assumptions and how you validated the approach.
- Anything else you think helps us understand your thinking: experiments, maps, visualizations, confidence/uncertainty, failed ideas or additional insights.

DEADLINE **14 calendar days from the time this case study is sent to you by email.**